

Saber Ayatollahi, CFA, MSc

Toronto, Canada • +1 (416) 856-1276 • saber.ayatollahi@gmail.com • www.linkedin.com/in/sayatollahi

SUMMARY

Investment and market risk specialist with ~7 years of institutional risk analytics experience, aligned to the Market Risk Coverage Lead - Vice President mandate at J.P. Morgan Asset Management Risk. Delegated sign-off authority on valuation and sensitivity outputs for multi-asset institutional portfolios of \$5-25bn per engagement at Moody's Analytics, serving buy-side pension, asset-management, and consulting clients. Hands-on VaR and CVaR portfolio optimization, risk decomposition, stress testing, and stochastic scenario modelling for pension and institutional mandates at Ortec Finance. Python and SQL analytics; CFA charterholder with dual MSc degrees.

CORE SKILLS

Market Risk Monitoring & Measurement • Value-at-Risk (VaR) & Conditional VaR (CVaR) • Stress Testing & Scenario Analysis • Portfolio Risk Analysis & Sensitivities • Risk Decomposition & Attribution • Investment Risk Oversight & Escalation • Liquidity & Cash Flow Risk Analytics • Portfolio Valuations & Risk Systems (PFaroe, GLASS) • Stochastic Modelling & Monte Carlo Simulation • Anomaly Detection & Validation Automation (AI-assisted code/output review) • Python, SQL & Analytics Pipelines • Model Governance & Independent Review

EXPERIENCE

Moody's Analytics - Asset Management & Buy-Side Solutions

Asst. Director, Modelling Services

Toronto, May 2023 - Present

Independent Risk Measurement & Assessment

- Holds delegated sign-off authority on valuation and sensitivity outputs for multi-asset institutional portfolios of \$5-25bn per engagement (~\$50bn+ cumulative), independently reviewing curve construction, spread calibration, and cross-asset interactions before production release.
- Validated derivatives pricing outputs across rates, FX, and inflation, confirming consistency of sensitivities and scenario impacts at portfolio-level aggregates.
- Serves on the model governance committee, contributing to methodology review, benchmarking and documentation standards, and model-performance assessment for client-delivered analytics.
- Reviewed aggregation logic converting security-level exposures into portfolio-level risk metrics feeding downstream risk and capital processes.

Portfolio Stress, Scenario & Liquidity Risk Analysis

- Led design and implementation of an enterprise multi-asset cash flow projection engine supporting base, stress, and reverse-stress scenarios across multi-year horizons.
- Architected configurable time-bucketed liquidity gap analytics (T+1 through multi-year), supporting funding, refinancing-risk, and asset-allocation decisions.
- Oversaw duration and rate-sensitivity analysis under parallel and non-parallel shocks across multi-asset institutional books.

Risk Oversight, Escalation & Stakeholder Engagement

- Escalated outputs lacking mathematical or economic defensibility and served as escalation point for client-critical analytical issues, interfacing directly with clients' Heads of Risk and investment stakeholders.
- Prepared analytical summaries for senior stakeholders covering exposure, scenario impacts, and portfolio sensitivities, translating quantitative output into investment-committee-ready narratives.
- Built agentic AI development workflows (Claude Code, Cursor IDE) automating validation scaffolding and anomaly detection in code and model outputs, cutting development cycle time an estimated 30-40% on comparable modules.
- Re-engineered manual spreadsheet workflows into scalable Python analytics pipelines with embedded logging, validation, and auditability controls.

Client Service Specialist

Toronto, May 2022 - May 2023

- Led onboarding and implementation for U.S. and Canadian pension funds, asset managers, and consulting firms migrating to the PFaroe DB (risk & ALM analytics) and PFaroe PM (portfolio management) platforms.
- Served as technical liaison between client investment teams and product owners, scoping requirements into development requests and validating model outputs post-deployment; contributed to migrating all assigned accounts off the legacy Calypso platform.

Ernst & Young (EY)

Senior Consultant, IFRS & Financial Risk Transformation

Toronto, Sep 2021 - Apr 2022

- Delivered IFRS 17 and IFRS 9 risk and finance transformation projects for Canadian and international insurance clients, aligning regulatory requirements with system implementation.
- Coordinated across actuarial, finance, IT, risk, and program-management teams on milestone delivery, governance documentation, and readiness processes.

Ortec Finance Canada

Consultant, Asset-Liability Management & Risk

Toronto, Feb 2019 - Sep 2021

- Performed asset-only and asset-liability (surplus) portfolio optimization on VaR and CVaR using Ortec's GLASS platform, with risk decomposition and near-optimal frontier analysis to test the robustness of allocation recommendations.
- Built and interpreted stochastic economic scenario generators assessing interest-rate risk and funding volatility under base-case and stressed environments.
- Advised institutional clients on strategic and tactical asset allocation trade-offs through stress testing and sensitivity analysis.
- Performed cash flow, liquidity, and hedging analysis across interest-rate, inflation, and currency risk for international institutional clients.
- Led onboarding and the ALM study for a three-plan university pension merger, on a team of three developing and validating the model capturing all funding-policy dynamics and evaluating duration, currency, inflation, and leverage overlay strategies.
- Presented study findings and risk recommendations on-site to investment committees at Canadian pension-fund clients.

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

- Chartered Financial Analyst (CFA) - CFA Institute, 2024
- MSc, Financial Modelling - Western University, 2018
- MSc, Chemical Engineering (Full Scholarship) - Western University, 2016